appeal procedure in the ‘claims and objections’ stage. In rural areas, the Gram Sabha will also mandatorily scrutinise the data in a specially convened meeting.

As per the latest *Economic Survey 2012-13* (which quotes the Ministry for Rural Development), enumeration under SECC 2011 has been completed in 2,339,926 enumeration blocks (EBs) comprising **94.26** per cent of the total EBs of all the states as on *31 December 2012*.

The government has constituted an ***Expert Committee*** under the chairpersonship of *Prof. Abhijit Sen*, Member Planning Commission, to examine the SECC indicators and the data analysis and recommend appropriate methodologies for determining classes of beneficiaries for different rural development programmes. It will consult states, experts, and civil society organisations while arriving at these methodologies.

POVERTY ALLEVIATION AND EMPLOYMENT GENERATION PROGRAMMES

To achieve inclusive development, several poverty-alleviation and employment-generation programmes are being implemented by the Government of India. Some of the important schemes are as follows:

I. MGNREGA

This flagship programme of the Government of India aims at enhancing livelihood security of households in rural areas of the country by providing at least one hundred days of guaranteed wage employment in a financial year to every household whose adult members volunteer to do unskilled manual work. It also mandates 1/3 participation for women. The primary ***objective*** of the scheme is to augment wage employment. This is to be done while also focusing on strengthening natural resource management through works that address causes of chronic poverty like drought, deforestation and soil erosion, and thus encourage sustainable development.